ProductTAMU Ideathon
Maintenance
Documentation

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Overall Note

The purpose of this document is to teach the user how to maintain their Heroku account along with the application inside it. The main topics include admin access control, deployment instructions, environment variables, and transfer of ownership.

Important Note

Make sure there is a payment method linked to your Heroku account at all times. Heroku will bill monthly based on app deployment and usage. If there is no payment method, the application will be suspended within a few days.

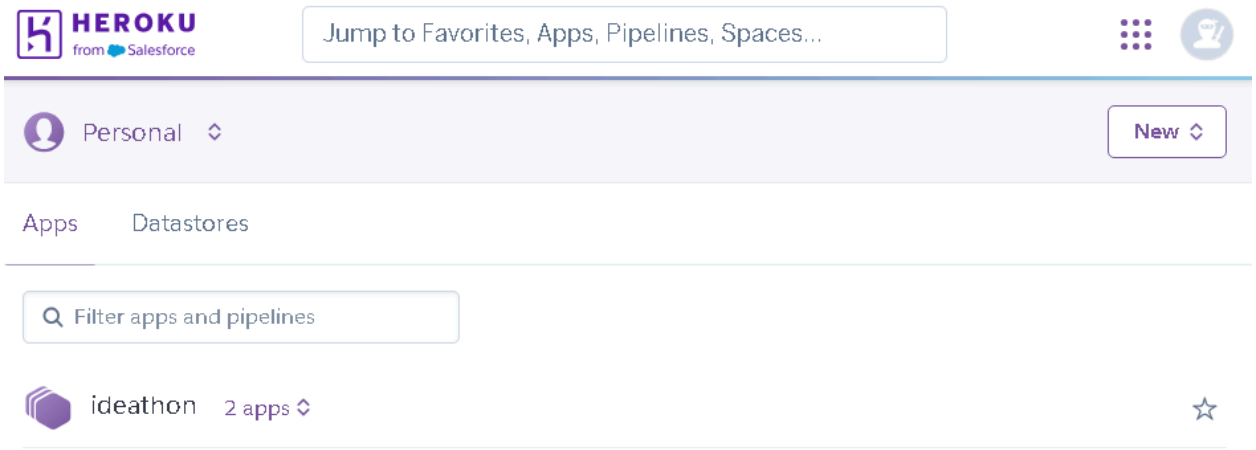
Heroku

What is Heroku and why is it significant?

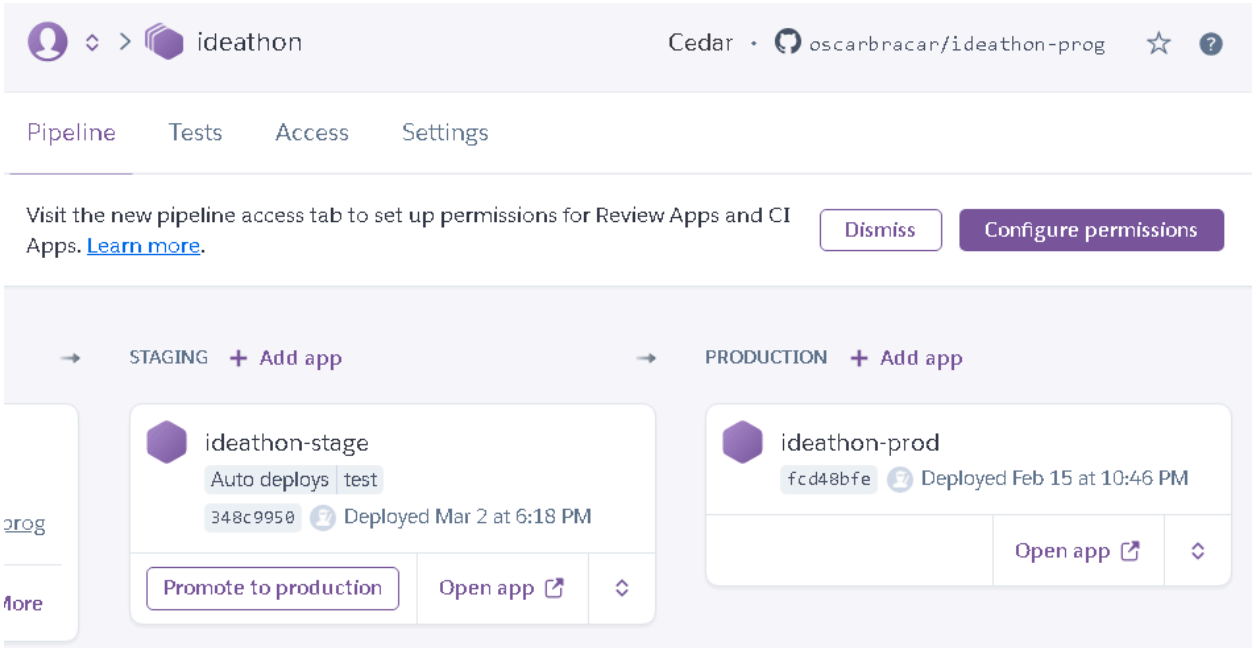
Heroku is a website that supports the deployment of a live/public web application. We will be using Heroku to deploy the Ideathon application. The Heroku pipeline provides a centralized location to view your applications, settings, etc.

Access the Application

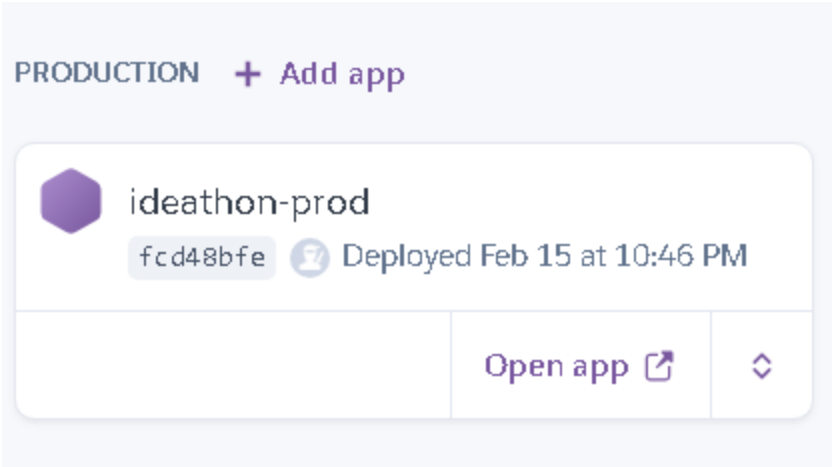
1. Visit https://id.heroku.com/login
2. Sign in with your own Heroku credentials that were set up at the beginning of the semester
3. Click on the ideathon pipeline in your dashboard



4. You should be directed to this page below:



5. The staging app is your backup app, the production app will be the app that is used by attendees. Click on open app to view your website and website link.



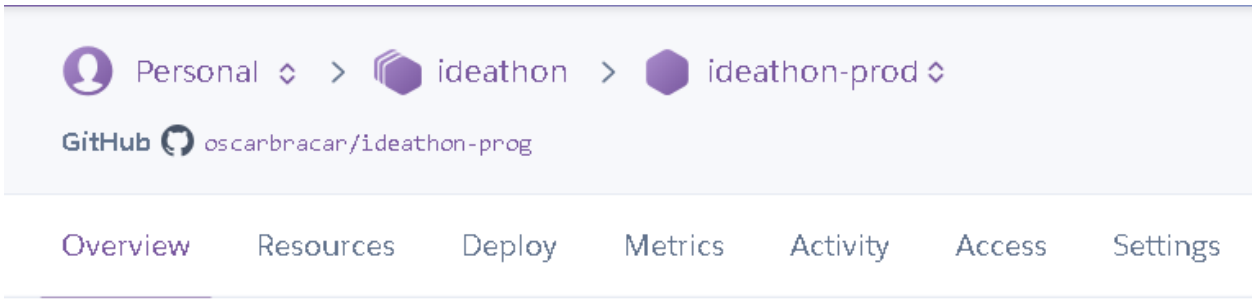
Application Specifics

Below are specifics on application access control, environment variables, and deployment. These instructions will be needed if you are changing admin/officers and if you want to work on the application in the future.

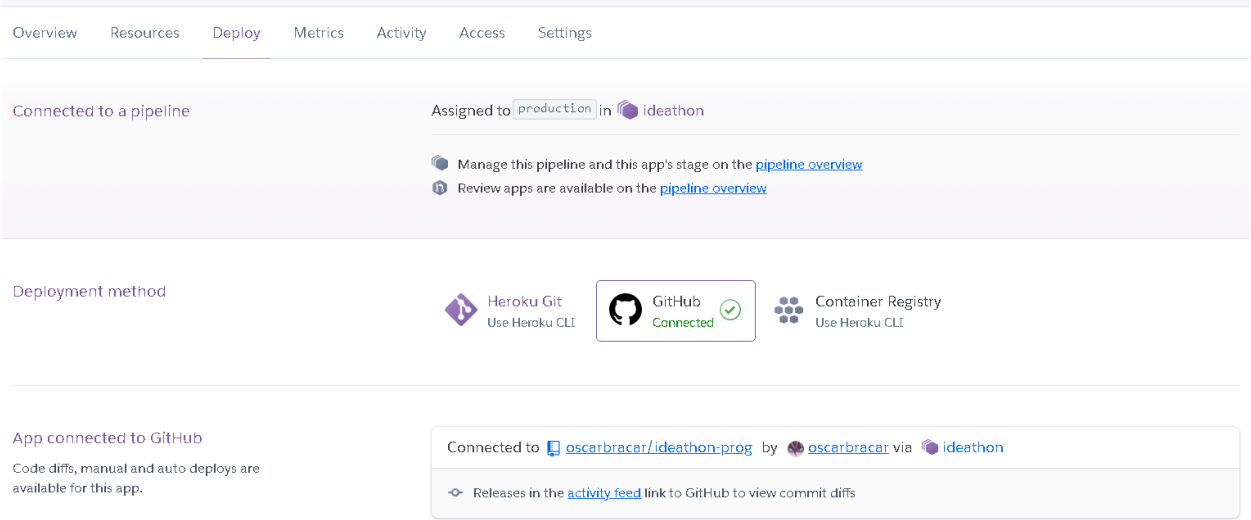
Application Deployment

To manually deploy the application, follow these instructions below:

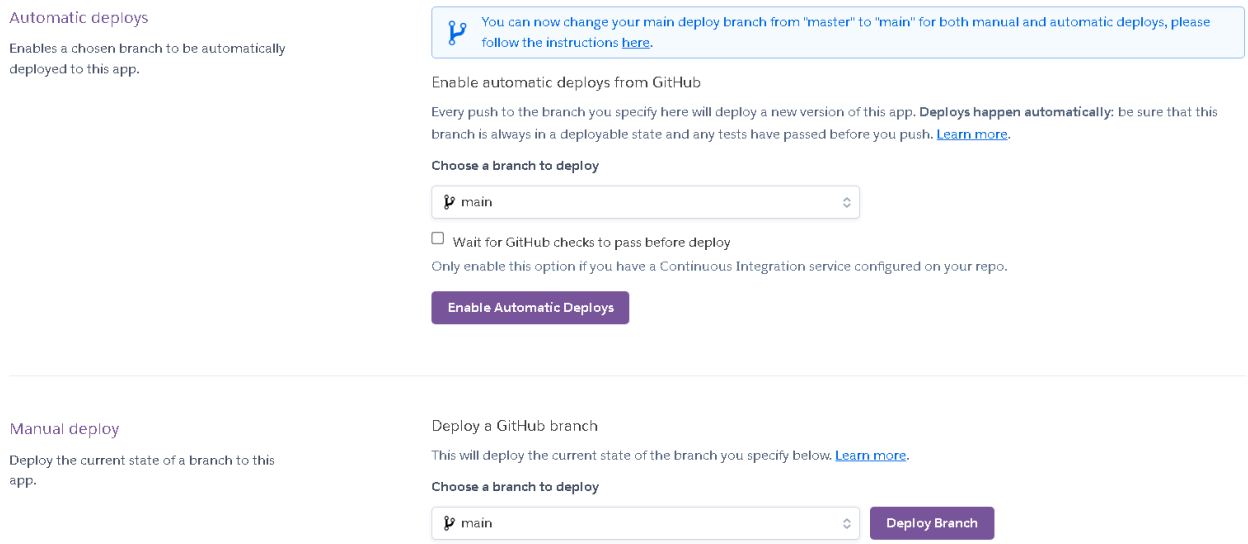
1. Click on the deploy tab within the staging or production app (whichever one you want to update)



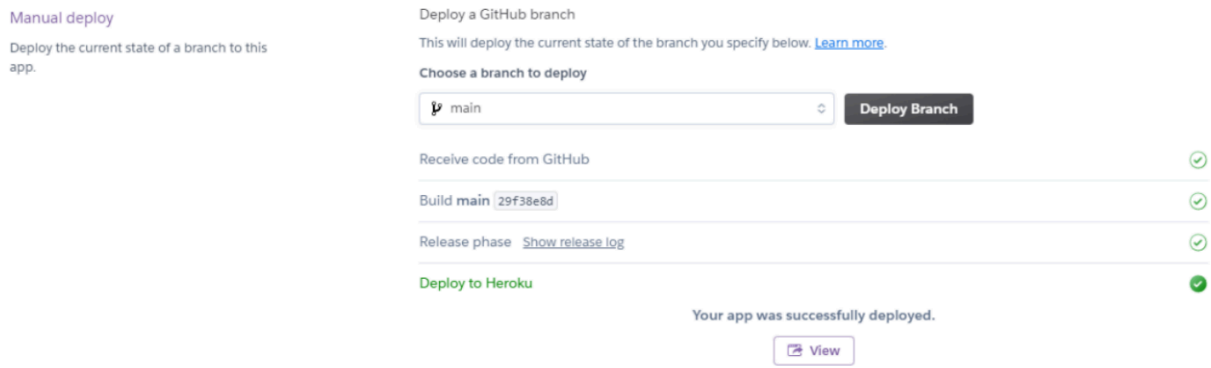
2. The deploy page will show you the connected Github repository, which you can change if needed



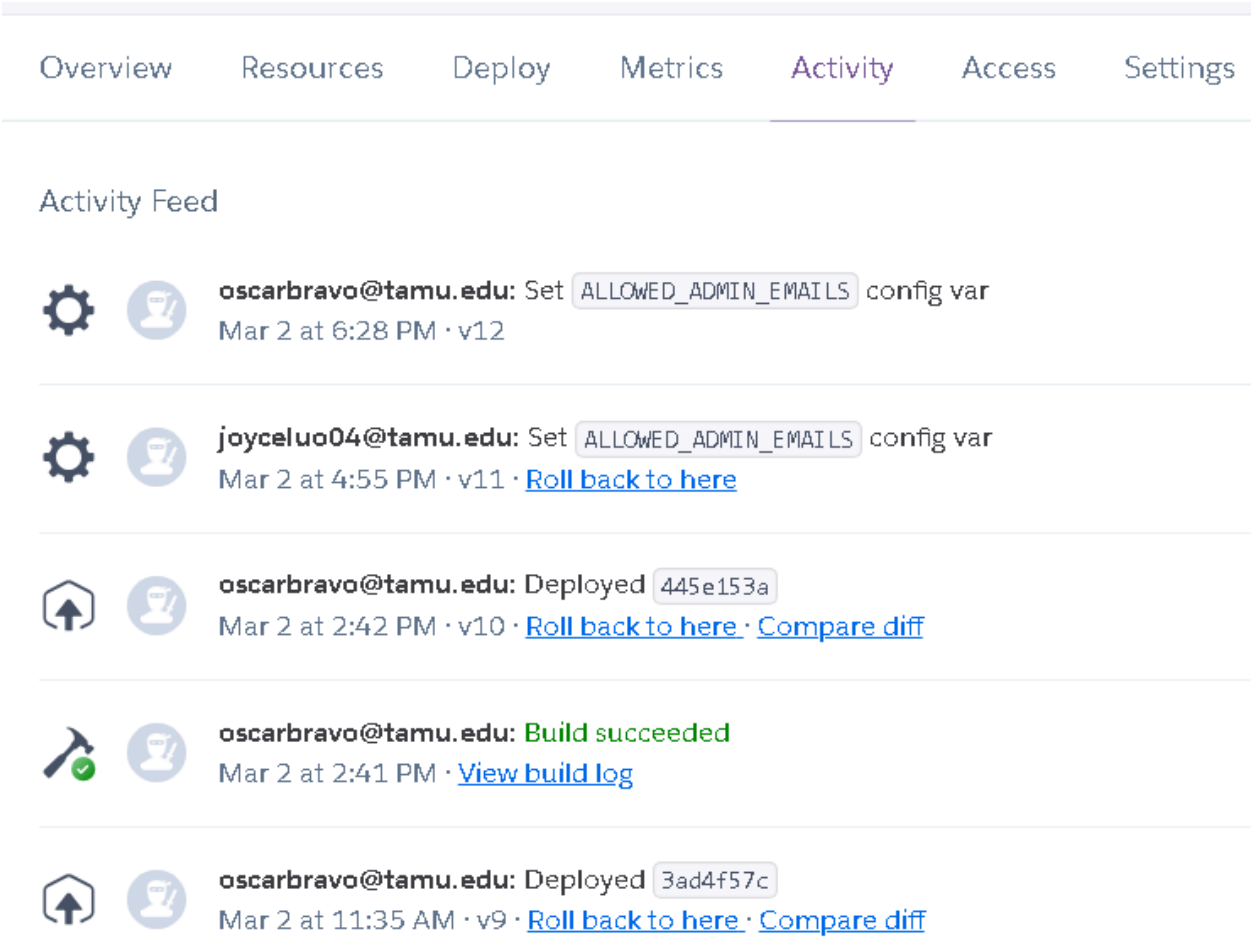
3. Automatic deployments can be set up for your chosen branch, currently that is “main”. If you want to manually deploy, you can choose a specific branch in the Manual Deploy section and hit “Deploy Branch”



4. Successful deployments will result in a success message such as this:

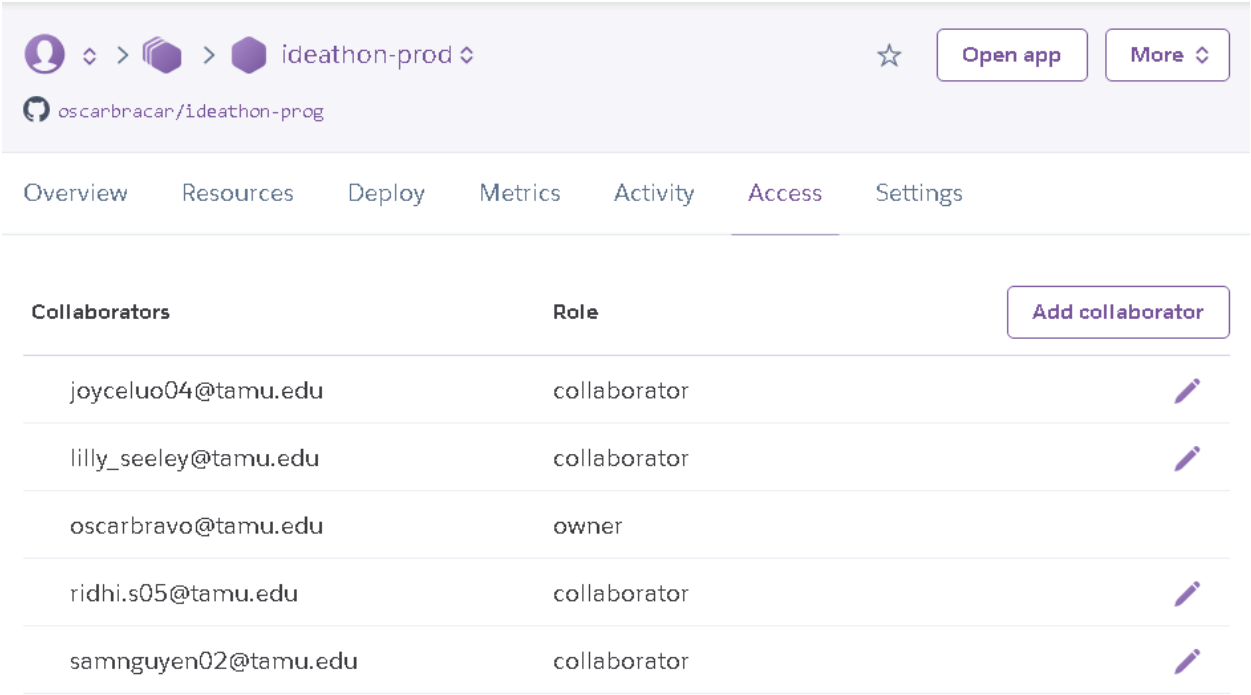


5. If the deploy is unsuccessful, click the Activity tab and view the deployment build log for any specific errors

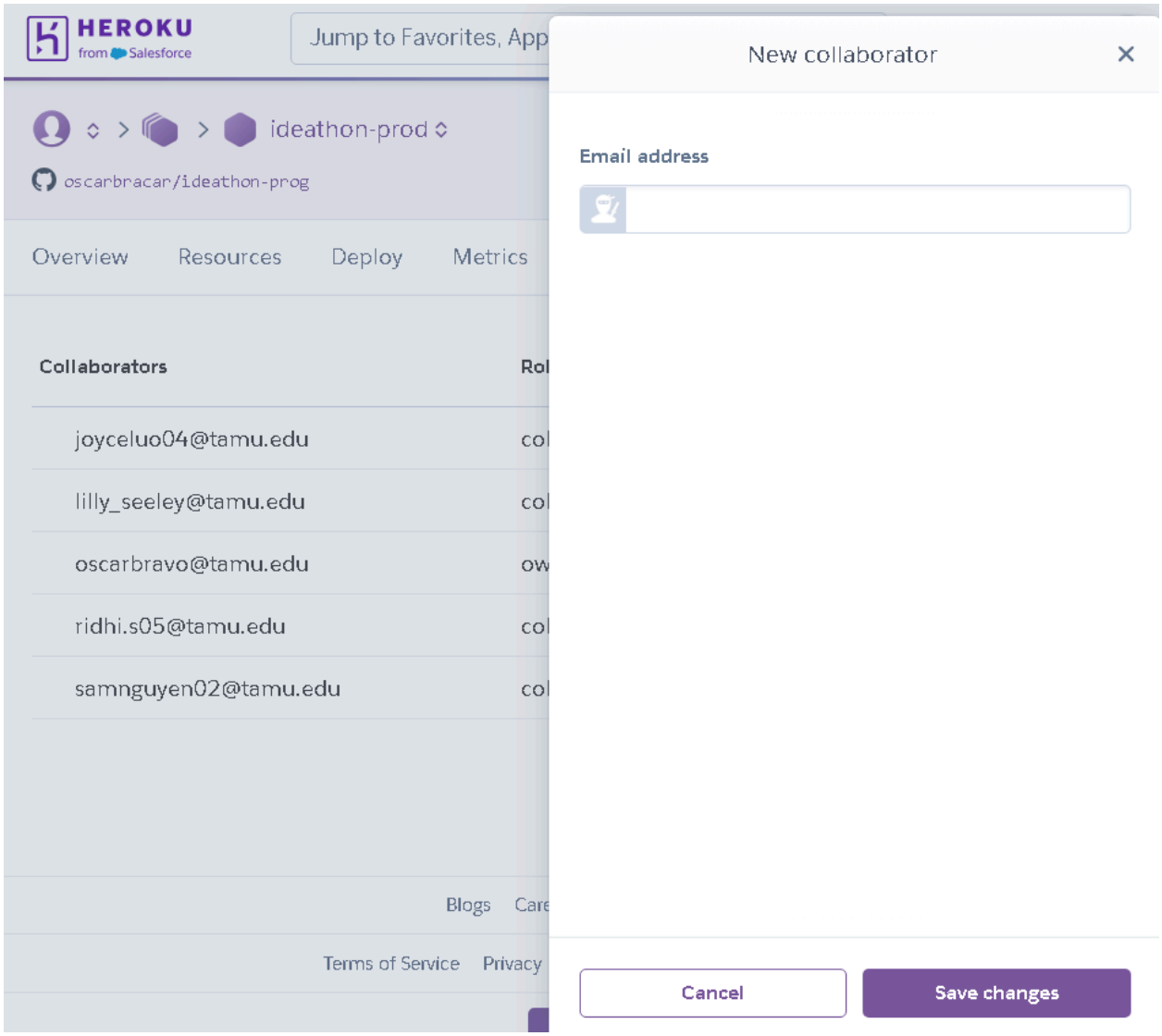


Add Heroku Access

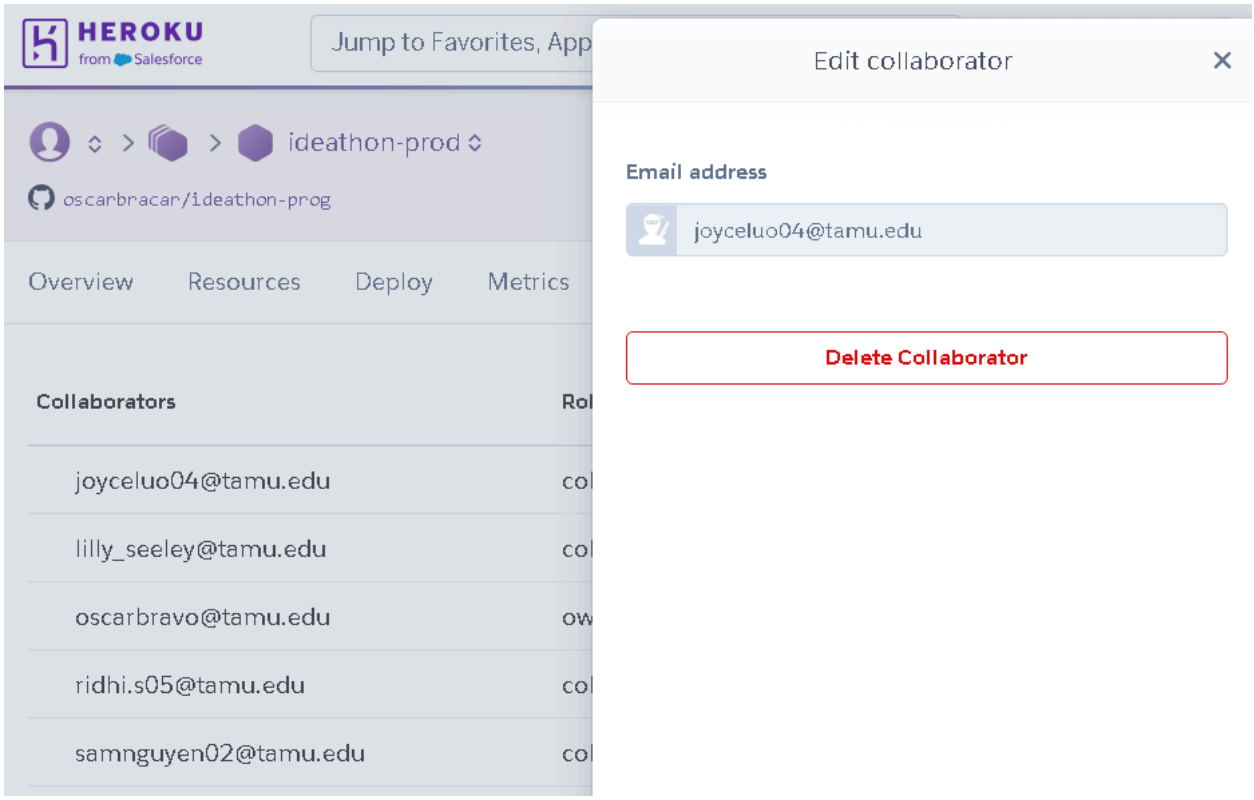
1. Click on the Access tab, you will see all of the current developers show up as collaborators, your email should show up as the owner once we transfer ownership



2. Click on the add collaborator button to invite someone to the Heroku pipeline



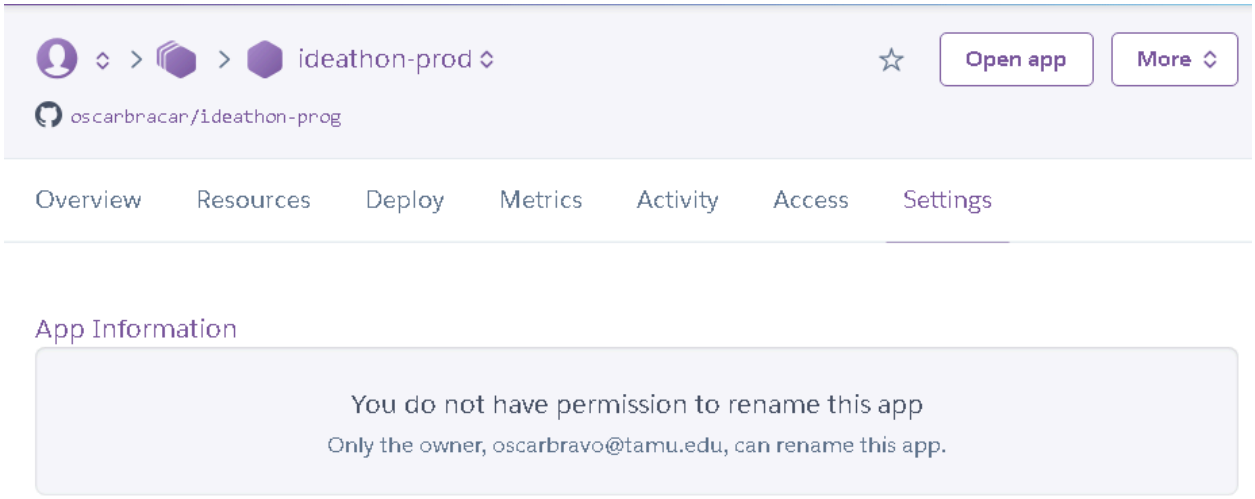
3. Click on the pencil icon next to a collaborators name to delete them



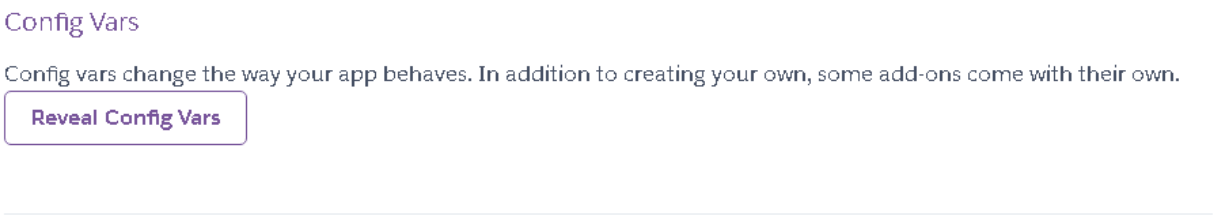
Environment Variables

There are 4 important configuration variables that are important to this app. The first is "ALLOWED_ADMIN_EMAILS", which directly controls who can login to the website's administrator dashboard through Google OAuth (ProductTAMU officers ONLY). "DATABASE_URL" is the postgreSQL database that is attached to your Heroku application as an add-on. The "GOOGLE_OAUTH_CLIENT_ID" and "GOOGLE_OAUTH_CLIENT_SECRET" are the API keys needed to successfully run Google OAuth login on your application. Instructions to view or change these variables are shown below:

1. Click on the Settings tab



2. Scroll down to the Config Vars section

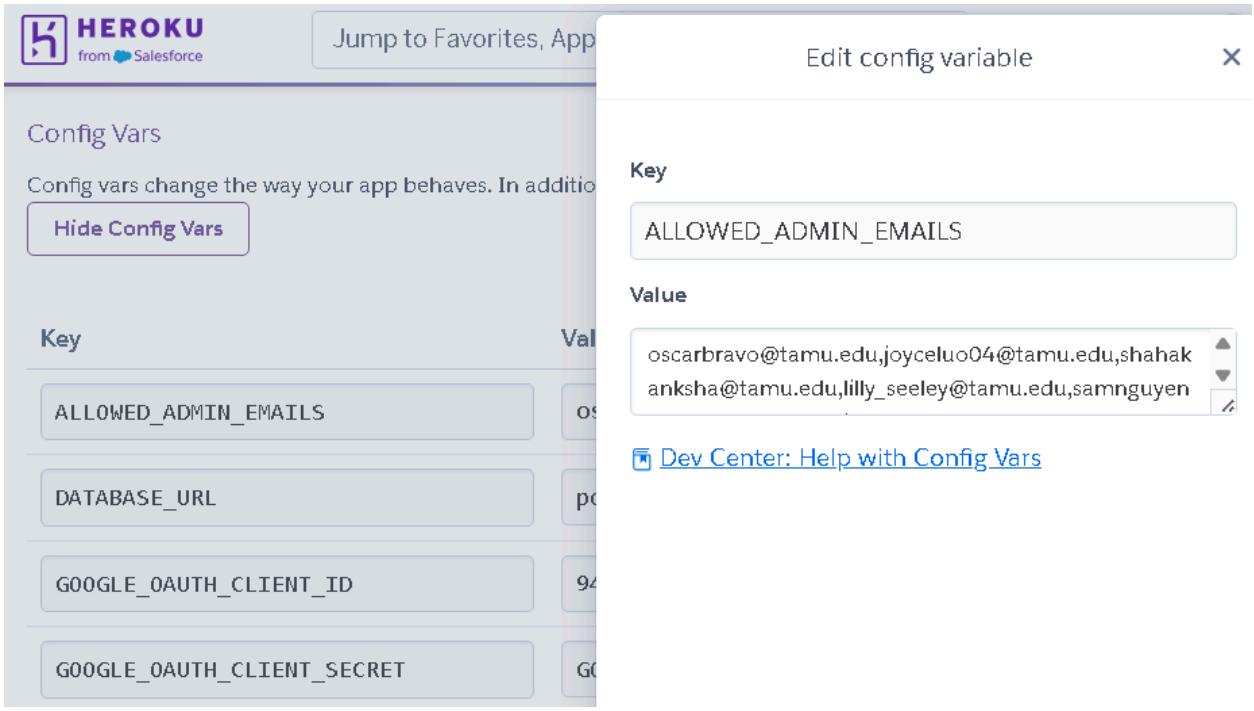


3. Click on "Reveal Config Vars" which will open up the variables for viewing

4. Make any changes you need BUT do not share these secret variables with any outside person.

Add website administrator access (through Google OAuth)

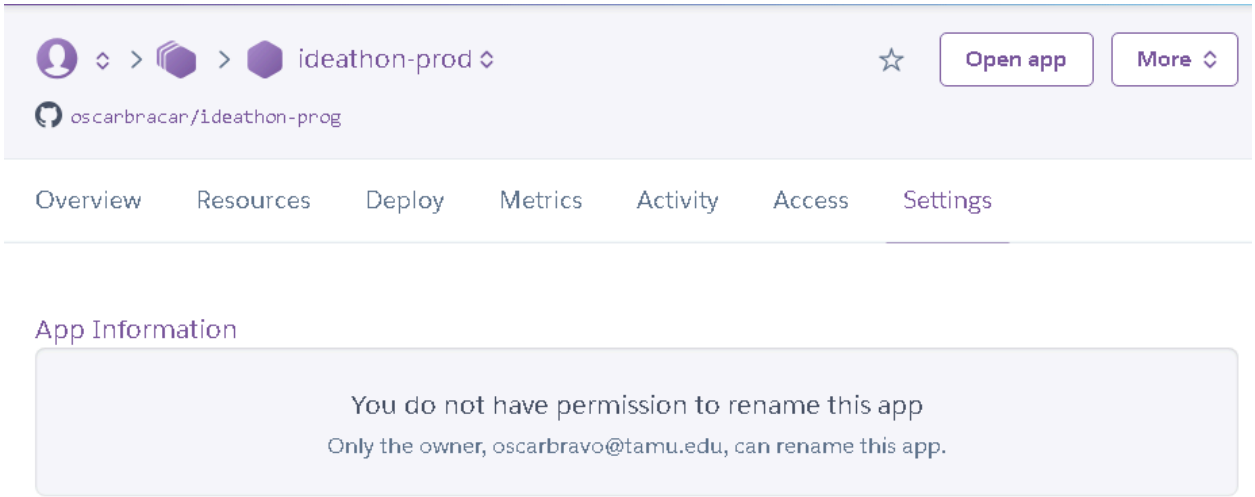
1. The “ALLOWED_ADMIN_EMAILS” config var is specific to controlling admin login access on the public website. Click the pencil icon to give or remove officer access.



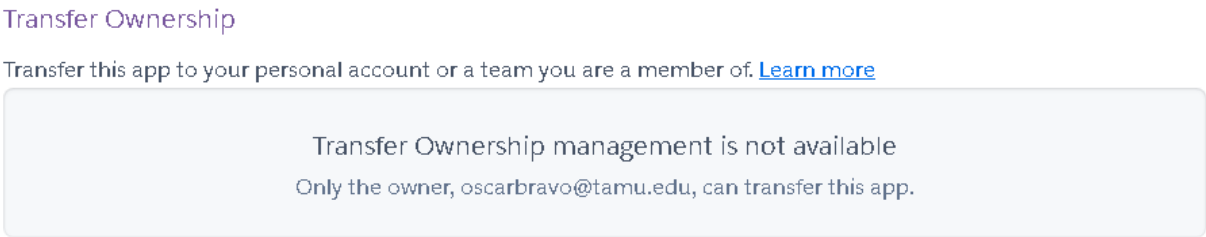
Transfer Application Ownership

Best practice is to have the organization president or an officer owning the application and therefore making any changes or payments. If there are any officer changes or handoffs, follow these instructions to transfer ownership.

1. Go to the Settings tab



2. Scroll to the transfer ownership section



3. If you are the owner, you will see a dropdown of a list of collaborators on the app, you can then choose someone to transfer ownership to.

Google OAuth API

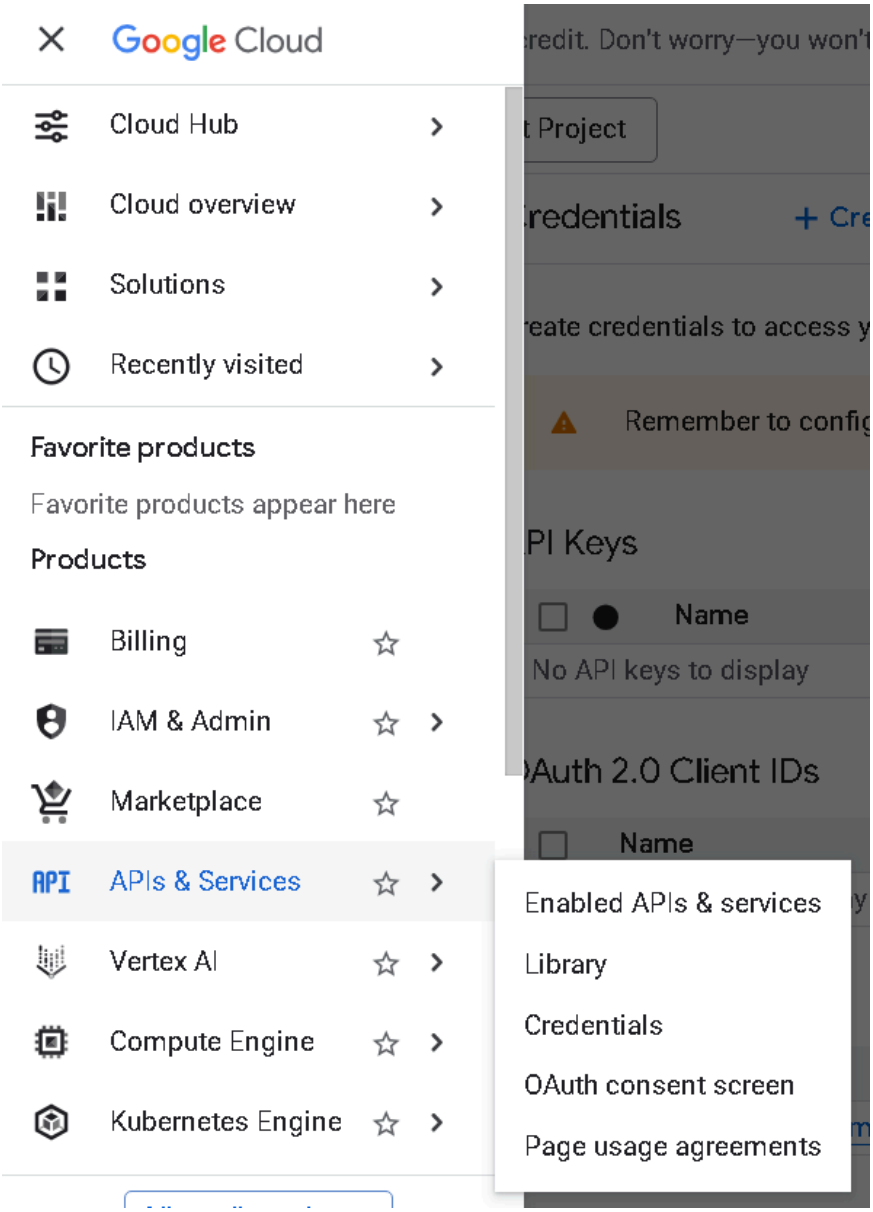
What is Google API and why is it significant?

The application uses the Google OAuth API to securely manage administrator login and access control. Google OAuth allows admins to sign in using their existing Google accounts without requiring the system to store passwords locally. This improves both security and usability by relying on Google's trusted authentication infrastructure.

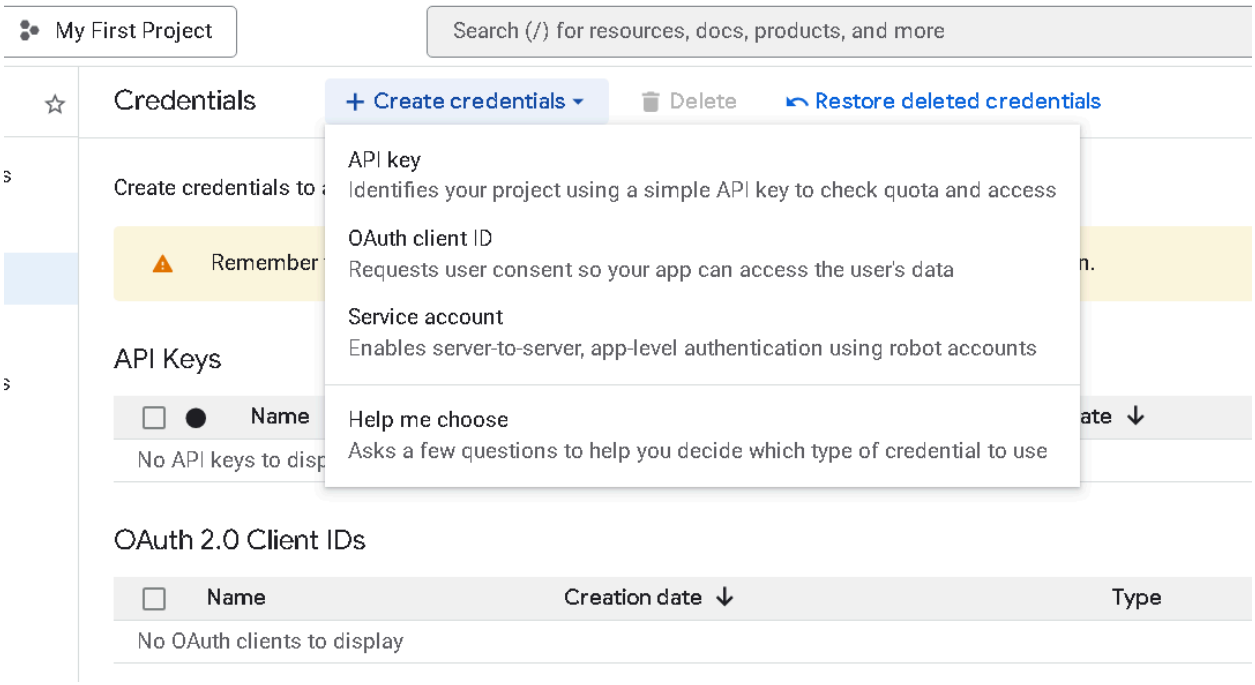
By integrating Google OAuth, the website ensures that only authorized users with approved accounts can access administrative features such as event management, content updates, and registration oversight. This reduces the risk of unauthorized access while simplifying account management for the development team.

In order to view or create new Google OAuth keys, follow these instructions below:

1. Visit https://console.cloud.google.com/cloud-resource-manager
2. Navigate to the credentials section in the hamburger menu



3. Click on “Create Credentials” to generate any new API keys or view your existing credentials on the page


My First Project
Search (/) for resources, docs, products, and more
Credentials
+ Create credentials
Delete
Restore deleted credentials
API key
Identifies your project using a simple API key to check quota and access
OAuth client ID
Requests user consent so your app can access the user's data
Service account
Enables server-to-server, app-level authentication using robot accounts
Help me choose
Asks a few questions to help you decide which type of credential to use
Create credentials to
Remember
API Keys
Name
No API keys to disp
OAuth 2.0 Client IDs
Name
Creation date
Type
No OAuth clients to display